

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 19 Summary

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In this lesson, we take a much-needed breather after the challenge of combining direct and indirect object pronouns. Today's focus is on **possessive adjectives** (my, your, his...) and **possessive pronouns** (mine, yours, his...), how to use them naturally in Spanish, and when *not* to use them.

1. Asking "Whose is it?"

Spanish uses the pattern:

- ¿De quién es + singular noun?
- ¿De quién son + plural noun?

Examples:

¿De quién es el coche? – Whose car is it?

¿De quién son las llaves? – Whose keys are they?

To clarify the subject, you can also say:

¿De quién es el coche? ¿De él? ¿De ella? ¿De María?

2. Possessive Adjectives

Used **before** a noun. Agree in **number** and sometimes **gender** with the noun they modify.

Meaning	Singular	Plural
My	mi perro	mis perros
Your (tú)	tu casa	tus casas
His/Her/Your (usted)/Their	su amigo	sus amigos
Our	nuestro coche / nuestra casa	nuestros coches / nuestras casas
Your (vosotros)	vuestro libro / vuestra casa	vuestros libros / vuestras casas

Note: "su" and "sus" can mean **his, her, your (formal), or their**, so context is important.

3. Possessive Pronouns

These replace a noun and show ownership. Used with **definite articles** when standing alone and must agree in **number and gender** with the noun they replace.

Meaning	Singular Masculine	Singular Feminine	Plural Masculine	Plural Feminine
Mine	el mío	la mía	los míos	las mías
Yours (tú)	el tuyo	la tuya	los tuyos	las tuyas
His/Hers/Yours (usted)/Theirs	el suyo	la suya	los suyos	las suyas
Ours	el nuestro	la nuestra	los nuestros	las nuestras
Yours (vosotros)	el vuestro	la vuestra	los vuestros	las vuestras

Examples:

—¿Es tu abrigo?

—No, **el mío** está en la cocina.

(Is it your coat? No, **mine** is in the kitchen.)

—¿Son tus llaves?

—No, **las mías** están en la mochila.

(Are they your keys? No, **mine** are in the backpack.)

4. Clarifying Ownership with “De”

Because “su” and “suyo” are ambiguous, Spanish often clarifies with:

- **Es su casa. → Es la casa de él / de ella / de María.**

Examples:

¿De quién es el carro?

—**Es suyo.**

—¿De ella?

—**Sí, es el carro de ella.**

5. When NOT to Use Possessives

In Spanish, possessives are **not normally used with body parts or clothing** when the owner is obvious. Use **definite articles** instead.

Examples:

—**Me duele el codo.** (My elbow hurts.)

—**Ponte la camisa.** (Put your shirt on.)

Use possessives **only to emphasize** ownership:

—**¡Es mi abrigo!** (That's my coat!)

6. Practice Tips

Most mistakes happen when choosing the wrong **gender/number agreement** or forgetting the **article** before possessive pronouns (el, la, los, las). Just follow the patterns:

- Use **mi/mis, tu/tus**, etc. before nouns.
- Use **el mío, la tuya, los suyos**, etc. when replacing nouns.
- Add **de + name/pronoun** to clarify ambiguous ownership with “su” and “suyo.”

Wrap-up

Well, that's it for today. Compared to the last lesson, this one should've felt like a much-needed breather. You now know how to ask *whose* something is, how to use possessive adjectives and pronouns correctly, and even when **not** to use them.

Stick with these patterns, and they'll start rolling off your tongue naturally. See you in the next lesson.